

Correction & Review Log

Errors found, and how they were fixed, across the model build

Jaehyuk Song | Independent analysis | 27 September 2026 | Covers model v1-v5.3 and the earlier FY2026 forecast

48 issues found across nine rounds of review: 42 fixed, 1 replaced by a later fix, 0 open, 5 noted as limitations. 17 were raised by me (Analyst) and 31 came from AI-assisted review of the model and the filings (Reviewer). Items 31-33 and 37 changed the numbers in model v5, items 41 and 43 changed them in model v5.1, and item 44 in model v5.2. Item 45 (model v5.3) explains the escalation weight and adds a sensitivity table without changing any figures; items 46-48 add a profit bridge, a note on Broking's asymmetric flow-through and the update plan, also without changing any figures.

A. Scenario model, v1 to v4

#	ISSUE	WHAT WAS WRONG	CORRECTION	EVIDENCE	RAISED BY	STATUS
1	Segment margins	Segment margins were set by judgment. No file supported them.	Replaced with flow-through margins (change in op. profit ÷ change in revenue) for each segment, using separate rates for growth and decline periods.	<i>Margin & Balance Sheet Analysis §3.4, Table 5</i>	Analyst	Fixed
2	FX overlay	The FX overlay (+1.9% / +5.0% / -1.1%) had no source.	Replaced with the company's own disclosed sensitivity ($\pm 5\%$ USD $\approx \pm \pounds 2.3\text{m}$ PBT, about 0.4% of profit per 1% move) applied to a GBP/USD path. Updated to AR2025 in v5 (#31).	<i>Annual Report 2024, Note 27</i>	Analyst	Fixed
3	Link acquisition	Financial's +54% half-on-half increase was put down to the Link acquisition.	Link (crude and futures broker) is in Broking. Financial's growth was organic: debt and equity capital markets and M&A.	<i>Interim 2026 p.5, p.10, Note 8</i>	Analyst	Fixed
4	Financial Bear case	Said Financial had never declined, and used Broking's 53.8% decline rate instead.	Financial did decline in FY23→FY24 ($\pounds 44.1\text{m} \rightarrow \pounds 42.6\text{m}$). Its own flow-through for that year, 93.3%, is now used.	<i>Annual Report 2024, segment note</i>	Reviewer	Fixed
5	Broking Base logic	+10% was described as being between +14.2% and +22.3%, but it was below both.	Changed to +18% (midpoint of the reference rates plus Link). Later replaced by the two-layer build (#8).	<i>Half-year segment data</i>	Analyst	Superseded
6	Formula error	A note starting with "=" was read as a formula (cell F9).	Rewritten as plain text; workbook recalculated and checked.	<i>Model QA (recalculation)</i>	Reviewer	Fixed
7	Citation	The Board's H2-weighting statement was cited as p.2.	Correct pages: p.1 (summary) and p.6 (outlook).	<i>Interim 2026</i>	Analyst	Fixed
8	H2 vs Board guidance	Base H2 operating profit of $\pounds 71.7\text{m}$ (+26% vs H1) went against the Board's statement that "the usual second-half weighting is unlikely this year" (31 Jul). The +14.2% "seasonal" figure was really a recovery from a weak H1 2025.	Rebuilt in two layers: Layer 1 follows the Board's guidance; Layer 2 adds the escalation from 9 Sep, for Broking only. H2 became Base $\pounds 62.09\text{m}$, Bull $\pounds 67.78\text{m}$, Bear $\pounds 43.22\text{m}$.	<i>Interim p.1, p.6, Note 2.4; Prelim Results; Sep 2026 news</i>	Reviewer	Fixed

B. Earlier FY2026 forecast model (23 Sep 2026)

#	ISSUE	WHAT WAS WRONG	CORRECTION	EVIDENCE	RAISED BY	STATUS
9	Tax rate label	H1 2026 actual net income used the 23.5% forecast rate.	The actual H1 rate (23.6%) was used for the actual period in the earlier forecast model.	<i>Financial Trend Analysis §2-1</i>	Analyst	Fixed

#	ISSUE	WHAT WAS WRONG	CORRECTION	EVIDENCE	RAISED BY	STATUS
10	Invested-capital basis	Thought that one invested-capital anchor included non-controlling interests (NCI) and the other did not.	Closed in v5 (#35). Both anchors are net assets (including NCI) minus net cash and available funds: 549.8 – 178.8 and 527.8 – 260.1. There was no mismatch.	<i>Interim 2026 p.20, p.21, p.30</i>	Analyst	Fixed
11	Credit loss timing	The allowance roll-forward cannot show when write-offs happen.	Added a $\pm$ £1.5m sensitivity note and a warning on the Bear sheet.	<i>Interim 2026 Note 10</i>	Analyst	Noted

C. Check of earlier work (26 Sep 2026)

#	ISSUE	WHAT WAS WRONG	CORRECTION	EVIDENCE	RAISED BY	STATUS
12	ROIC text in Appendix §7	The Appendix said the model's 29.9% ROIC used an old two-point average and that a three-point average gave 25.1%. This was the wrong way round: the model already used a three-point average, and 25.1% came from a hand-typed Dec 2026E figure the model never produced.	Rewritten with the model's own figures: ROIC 27.46% / 28.09% / 22.94% (Base/Bull/Bear) after #8.	<i>Model cells D46/D47, recalculated</i>	Reviewer	Fixed
13	Link holding period	Link's H1 2026 holding period was given as 103 days.	Changed to 104 days (18 Mar to 30 Jun), then to 105 in v5 to count both ends like the H2 day counts (#37). Link adds +2.09pp to Broking H2 growth.	<i>Interim 2026 Note 8; date calculation</i>	Reviewer	Fixed
14	Count in this log's header	The header said "10 of 13 raised by analyst". The fixed count had been copied into the raised-by count.	Recounted from the table: Analyst 8, Reviewer 5 at the time. Corrected to 9 of 14, including this row.	<i>Row count, Sections A–C</i>	Analyst	Fixed
15	DSO and T+2 assumptions	Real DSO was 81.5 / 83 / 90 days across Base / Bull / Bear with no reason given, and Bull was worse than Base. T+2 settlement balances (85 / 110 / 65) were also typed in with no basis.	Real DSO held at the H1 2026 actual in all scenarios. T+2 balances changed to a formula linked to segment growth (first Broking, then Financial, see #18). This section did not affect profit, cash or ROIC at the time.	<i>Cell formulas, comments and Summary notes</i>	Analyst	Fixed

D. Sheet-by-sheet review with the model open (26 Sep 2026, afternoon)

#	ISSUE	WHAT WAS WRONG	CORRECTION	EVIDENCE	RAISED BY	STATUS
16	H1 2025 Broking revenue (C76)	The cell labelled "H1 2025 Broking revenue" held 253.8, which is H2 2025 (FY25 476.0 – H1 222.2). This made the Layer 2 escalation overlay about half as big as it should be.	Corrected to 222.2. Layer 2 overlay: Base 5.8%→11.1%, Bull 11.7%→22.2%. FY op. profit: Base 118.9→123.2, Bull 124.6→133.2. ROIC: Base 27.46%→28.56%, Bull 28.09%→30.18%.	<i>Interim 2026 p.7 and Note 3 p.25; 2025 Prelim Results p.25</i>	Reviewer	Fixed
17	Financial 0% growth: source	The Base case cited the Board's group-level "no H2 weighting" comment as the reason for holding Financial at 0%.	Changed: 0% is used so that Financial's record H1 (+66% YoY) is not extrapolated. It is not based on the Board comment, and Financial's own H2 outlook is positive.	<i>Interim 2026 p.10</i>	Reviewer	Fixed
18	T+2 balances linked to the wrong segment	T+2 settlement balances (row 21) were linked to Broking growth, based on an assumption that was never checked.	The filing says these balances are in the Financial division, so they now follow Financial growth (D53). No effect on profit or ROIC. The surface DSO check moved closer to the actual 118.6 days (Bull 123.3→117.8).	<i>Interim 2026 Note 10, p.29</i>	Analyst	Fixed

#	ISSUE	WHAT WAS WRONG	CORRECTION	EVIDENCE	RAISED BY	STATUS
19	ESOP and lease below H1 level	H2 ESOP buybacks (£15 / 20 / 8m) and lease repayments (£3m) were below the H1 2026 actuals (£24.0m and £5.3m) with no reason given.	Both set to the H1 2026 actual in all scenarios. Net cash: Base 268.2→256.9, Bull 239.7→233.4, Bear 243.2→224.9; ROIC change under 0.1pp. The ESOP figure was changed again in v5 (#32).	<i>Interim 2026 p.22 (financing activities)</i>	Reviewer	Fixed
20	Old comment on Broking growth	The comment on D52 still described the v2 method (+18% / +28% / −8%), although D52 had become a two-layer formula in v3.	Comment rewritten to match the formula. It also notes an open question: Layer 1 keeps H1's high revenue level and Layer 2 adds a second shock, so the two may overlap.	<i>D52 formula vs comment</i>	Reviewer	Fixed
21	Head office cost growth: no driver	H2 head office cost growth (Base +8%) was much lower than the H1 2026 actual (+32.4% YoY), and neither filing explains either figure.	Checked two possible reasons (acquisition integration; National Insurance on share awards). Neither applies: acquisition costs are a separate line, and the NI comment is about the Broking margin. No change at the time; the assumption was changed later (#22).	<i>Interim 2026 Note 3, p.6</i>	Analyst	Noted

E. Head office costs and other project files (26 Sep 2026, evening)

#	ISSUE	WHAT WAS WRONG	CORRECTION	EVIDENCE	RAISED BY	STATUS
22	Head office cost growth: changed	The model still used +8% / +15% / −5% by scenario, based on a loose link to Broking headcount.	Held at the H1 2026 actual (£28.6m) in all scenarios, the same rule used for DSO, ESOP and lease. FY op. profit: Base 123.18→125.49, Bull 133.25→137.63, Bear 100.02→98.60. ROIC: Base 28.51%→29.10%, Bull 30.13%→31.19%, Bear 22.90%→22.54%.	<i>Same rule as #15 and #19; no new filing evidence</i>	Reviewer	Fixed
23	NI quote used for head office (other project files)	Two research files (operating-profit-structure \$5 and financial-trend-analysis \$2-3) used the Interim p.6 sentence on National Insurance to explain head office cost growth. The sentence is about the Broking division's operating margin. The same error had been fixed in a third file on 25 Sep but not in these two.	Both files corrected. The quote is now described as Broking-only, and the head office driver as not disclosed.	<i>Interim 2026 p.6</i>	Analyst	Fixed

F. First full check before locking the file (27 Sep 2026)

#	ISSUE	WHAT WAS WRONG	CORRECTION	EVIDENCE	RAISED BY	STATUS
24	Head office cost breakdown not disclosed	The model had no note on what the £28.6m of head office costs is made of (staff, overheads, other).	Checked both filings: no breakdown is given. The 'unallocated assets and liabilities' note covers cash, pensions and tax on the balance sheet, not P&L costs. Comment added to C59. Status changed to Noted in v5 because the breakdown is still unknown.	<i>AR2025 Note 4; Interim 2026 Note 3</i>	Analyst	Noted
25	Old comment on Bull Financial growth (D53)	The Bull D53 comment still said +15%, although the cell had been +8% since 26 Sep. During review, the AI read the comment instead of the cell and reported +15%.	Comment rewritten to +8%, based on the FY2025 H2 vs H1 change (£28.9m→£31.2m, +7.96%). The error was caught in the same conversation; the cell itself was always correct.	<i>Bull D53 value vs comment</i>	Reviewer	Fixed

#	ISSUE	WHAT WAS WRONG	CORRECTION	EVIDENCE	RAISED BY	STATUS
26	Old DSO wording in B34 comments	The Bull and Bear B34 comments explained the cash multiple with DSO of 83 and 90 days, but DSO has been 81.5 days in all scenarios since #15.	Comments rewritten: DSO is the same in all scenarios, and the difference in receivables comes from revenue size and T+2 balances. The multiples were not changed at that point.	<i>D20 in all three sheets</i>	Reviewer	Fixed
27	Wrong receivables figures in B34 comments	The same comments gave Jun→Dec receivables changes of about £15m (Base), £52m (Bull) and £6m (Bear). The model showed £10.2m, £26.1m and –£8.1m.	Recalculated D23 – C23 for each scenario and corrected the comments. No figures in the model changed.	<i>D23 and C23, all three sheets</i>	Reviewer	Fixed
28	Bear Financial –3%: deal risk	Bear Financial growth (–3%) is based on FY23→FY24, a general slowdown. A Bear case driven by the Middle East could be worse if signed deals are cancelled.	Not changed, because there is no data to size a bigger fall. The limitation is noted on the Bear sheet.	<i>Bear D53; AR2024 segment note</i>	Analyst	Noted

G. Second full check, with every source page re-read: model v5 (27 Sep 2026)

#	ISSUE	WHAT WAS WRONG	CORRECTION	EVIDENCE	RAISED BY	STATUS
29	Summary notes out of date (9, 11, 15)	The notes still used v3 figures: Bear H2 margin about 11.1% and FY 12.5% (v4 was 10.76% and 12.30%, so Bear H2 was below the lowest past half, not close to it); Broking margins of 21.7% / 22.0%; a ROIC gap of about 3pp (4.15pp in v4). Note 7 gave the wrong AR2025 note number.	Rewritten from the v5 workbook: Bear H2 10.6% (below H1 2025's 11.0%), FY 12.2%; Broking 20.9% → 21.5% → 21.9%; gap about 2.5pp; AR2025 Note 4.	<i>Model recalculation; Interim 2026 p.19</i>	Reviewer	Fixed
30	Old Bear ECL comment (B26)	The Bear B26 comment explained the £11.5m credit loss charge with 'DSO 90 days'. DSO has been the same in all scenarios since #15. The #26 fix changed B34 but missed this cell.	Rewritten: the charge reflects credit risk in a downturn (my assumption), not slower collection.	<i>Bear B26 vs D20</i>	Reviewer	Fixed
31	FX sensitivity from an older report	The model used AR2024 Note 27 (about 0.4% of profit per 1% USD move). AR2025 Note 27 gives +£5.6m / –£5.1m on FY2025 PBT of £90.6m, about 1.24% / 1.13% per 1%, roughly three times larger.	B69 now uses the AR2025 figures (rows 90–94). H2 op. profit: Base 68.69→70.15, Bull 80.83→84.50, Bear 41.80→41.23.	<i>AR2025 Note 27 p.93; 2025 Prelim Results p.1</i>	Reviewer	Fixed
32	ESOP buybacks too high for H2	H2 ESOP buybacks were set at the H1 2026 level (£24.0m). In 2025 the H2 figure was only £1.8m (FY £33.4m – H1 £31.6m); most buying happens in H1.	H2 2026 ESOP set to £1.8m in all scenarios. No effect on ROIC; net cash £22.2m higher.	<i>2025 Prelim Results p.23; Interim 2026 p.22</i>	Reviewer	Fixed
33	Cash conversion multiple: wrong reasoning	The 2.0x / 1.5x / 2.2x multiples were explained by bonus timing and a '£50.6m bonus drawdown'. Net cash and available funds is already after accrued bonuses, so bonus timing does not affect it. The filing shows a £30.9m fall in the bonus accrual; £50.6m is not in the filing.	B34 now uses H2 2025: (net cash +33.0 plus capex, dividend, ESOP and lease payments 22.1) ÷ op. profit 45.3 = 1.22x in all scenarios. With #31, #32 and #37, net cash: Base 261.5→231.6, Bull 240.0→243.6, Bear 221.8→202.2; ROIC 29.10%→28.29%, 31.19%→31.52%, 22.54%→21.74%. Working capital was added in v5.1 (#41).	<i>Interim 2026 p.22, p.30; 2025 Prelim Results p.23</i>	Reviewer	Fixed

#	ISSUE	WHAT WAS WRONG	CORRECTION	EVIDENCE	RAISED BY	STATUS
34	Same citation error again (B60; Appendix \$2, \$4)	The B60 comment and Appendix \$2 and \$4 again linked Financial's 0% to the Board's guidance, the error fixed in #17.	B60 sentence removed. Appendix \$2 now applies Layer 1 to Broking only, and \$4 gives the correct reason for Financial's 0%.	#17; Interim 2026 p.6, p.10	Reviewer	Fixed
35	178.8 wrongly called NCI	Appendix \$7 called the £178.8m deduction 'NCI'. It is net cash and available funds; NCI is £3.4m. Both anchors are on the same basis, so the #10 mismatch did not exist.	Appendix \$7 corrected and #10 closed.	Interim 2026 p.20, p.21, p.30	Reviewer	Fixed
36	Wrong figure in #18	#18 said the Bull surface DSO moved from 121.4. It was 123.3 (121.4 was Base).	#18 corrected.	Model recalculation	Reviewer	Fixed
37	Link days counted differently	C78 used 104 days (not counting 18 March), while the H2 day counts (184 and 114) count both ends. Link revenue is reported from 18 March.	C78-C80 are now date formulas that count both ends: 105 days. Link adds +2.09pp (was +2.13pp); H2 op. profit -0.04 in Base and Bull.	Interim 2026 Note 8 p.28	Reviewer	Fixed
38	Page and note references	Several references were wrong: cash flow statement p.23 (is p.22); Note 10 p.28 (p.29); Financial quote p.10 (p.5); Prelim p.34 (the segment note is p.25); AR2025 segment Note 3 (Note 4); AR2024 'Strategic Report' (Note 4, p.170). D54 used the H1 Suez Canal figure (+25% YoY) as if it were H2 guidance.	All corrected in comments, labels, Summary notes and the Appendix. D54 is now marked as my assumption, with the p.12 outlook as background. Tax rate label now cites Interim Note 5.	Page checks in all four filings	Reviewer	Fixed
39	Errors in Appendix text	\$4 said Support's margin fell for five halves in a row, but it rose from 5.5% to 6.5% in H1 2026. \$6 called FY24→FY25 a decline for Support and Research, but revenue grew. \$4 gave the Research effect of the Link split the wrong way round. \$1 said acquisition costs would be about £2.3m per half, leaving out amortisation of £38.1m of intangibles.	All four corrected.	Interim 2026 p.25, Note 4; 2025 Prelim Results p.25	Reviewer	Fixed
40	Formatting and labels	Formula cells B21 and D52 had the yellow input fill. The Layer 2 weight (0.5 / 1.0) was typed inside the C86 formula. The 9 Sep start date (from news) was marked as from the filings. The ClarkSea +91% figure had no source tag. The revenue chart started at about £740m, which made the gaps look bigger. #24 was marked Fixed although the breakdown is still unknown.	Fills removed; weight moved to its own input cell (B86); news-sourced items tagged; chart axes start at zero; #24 set to Noted.	Workbook check	Reviewer	Fixed

H. Working capital, credit losses, escalation weight, profit bridge and cell-by-cell checks: models v5.1 to v5.3 (27 Sep 2026)

#	ISSUE	WHAT WAS WRONG	CORRECTION	EVIDENCE	RAISED BY	STATUS
41	Working capital not in cash	With one multiple for all scenarios (#33), changes in receivables did not affect cash, so Bull's larger receivables build and Bear's release made no difference. A review note had also quoted the Bull build as +£26m, which included about £7m of T+2 balances that are matched by payables.	D34 = H2 op. profit × 1.25x (H2 2025 before its own £1.4m receivables increase, rows 111-115) – the scenario's change in receivables excluding T+2 (Base +£10.1m, Bull +£19.2m, Bear –£5.6m). Profit unchanged. Net cash: Base 231.6→223.7, Bull 243.6→227.0, Bear 202.2→209.0. ROIC: 28.29%→28.13%, 31.52%→31.14%, 21.74%→21.85%.	2025 Prelim Results p.23; Interim 2026 p.22, Note 10 p.29	Reviewer	Fixed
42	Acquisition cost items added to £5.9m	Summary note 7, Appendix \$1 and this log (v5) listed 1.4 + 0.9 + 0.1 + 3.5 as the £5.8m of acquisition costs. That adds to £5.9m; the £0.1m is interest in finance costs.	Corrected in all three: £5.8m in operating profit (1.4 + 0.9 + 3.5) plus £0.1m interest = £5.9m before tax.	Interim 2026 p.19, Note 4 p.25	Reviewer	Fixed
43	Real DSO typed in, not calculated	Real DSO was typed as 81.5 days; the actual figure is $184.6 \div (2 \times 413.5) \times 365 = 81.47$. Once receivables feed cash (#41), this adds about £0.07m of extra receivables in every scenario.	C20 is now a formula and B20 links to it.	C20, C22, C6 in all three sheets	Reviewer	Fixed
44	Credit loss charge not in operating profit	The H2 credit loss charge was set by scenario (Base £7.7m, Bull £9.5m, Bear £11.5m), but operating profit comes from the segment flow-through margins and did not include the difference.	The charge above the H1 2026 level (£7.7m, already inside the segment margins) is now taken off H2 operating profit (row 65): Base £0.0m, Bull –£1.8m, Bear –£3.8m. H2 op. profit: Bull 84.46→82.66, Bear 41.23→37.43. ROIC: Bull 31.14%→30.72%, Bear 21.85%→20.97%. Base unchanged.	Interim 2026 p.19 (net impairment losses £7.7m)	Reviewer	Fixed
45	Layer 2 weight: reason and range	The Base weight of 0.5 was explained only by the attacks targeting Saudi-linked shipping and by reported de-escalation talks, and results were shown only at 0.5, although no data sets the weight.	Reason restated: the September escalation is treated as about half the size of the H1 shock, the closure of the Strait of Hormuz; Bull's 1.0 assumes it becomes as large, as an upper bound. Added a live sensitivity table for weights 0 to 1.0 (Base H2 op. profit £60.8m to £79.4m, ROIC 26.1% to 30.1%); £9.3m of Base H2 operating profit comes from the escalation layer. No figures changed.	Interim 2026 p.4; Base Case rows 118-137; Summary rows 55-62	Analyst	Fixed
46	Bull – Base bridge: first draft did not add up	The first bridge draft put the Bull – Base gap at £12.15m with Broking 74.7% and FX + £0.94m. It was typed in by hand, left out the Bull-only credit loss charge (–£1.8m) and understated FX, so it did not tie to the model's H2 operating profit.	Rebuilt with live formulas (Summary rows 64-74): each segment links to Base/Bull Case I52-I55, head office to D61, credit loss to D65, FX = D64 × D70. Gap £12.55m: Broking +8.98 (71.5%), Financial +1.69, Support +0.15, Research +0.27, credit loss –1.80, FX +3.26. Check row = 0 in both scenarios. No figures changed.	Summary rows 64-74; Base/Bull Case D61-D71	Reviewer	Fixed

#	ISSUE	WHAT WAS WRONG	CORRECTION	EVIDENCE	RAISED BY	STATUS
47	Broking flow-through asymmetry note	The draft note had the asymmetry the wrong way round and cited a cell ("F52 decline rate") that does not exist.	Rewritten from the Section 6 data: 26.1% on growth (H1 25→H1 26, +88.1 / +23.0) and 53.8% on decline (FY24→FY25, −53.3 / −28.7). £1 of lost Broking revenue costs about 54p of operating profit; £1 gained adds about 26p. Consistent with Bear falling £32.7m below Base while Bull is £12.6m above. No figures changed.	AR2025 Note 4; Interim 2026 p.19; Appendix Section 6	Reviewer	Fixed
48	Update plan stated	The files did not say how the model will be kept current once H2 2026 results are published.	Added a line to the Summary sheet and the Appendix version note: the model will be updated when H2 2026 actuals are released, and an H1 2027 extension is planned.	Summary row 77; Appendix version note	Analyst	Noted

Basis. Operating profit is shown before acquisition-related costs (H1 2026: £56.8m, against £51.0m statutory). These costs will continue: the Link escrow and the Link and Zuma share awards come to about £2.3m per half, plus amortisation of the £38.1m of acquired intangibles. In H1 2026 they were £5.8m in operating profit plus £0.1m of interest. Interim 2026 Notes 4 and 8.

How this log was kept. I built the model with AI assistance and checked each assumption before using it. Items 1–8 were found while building the model; items 12–23 when going back over it against the filings on 26 September; items 24–48 in the full checks on 27 September, in which every cell, comment and source page was checked again. The full check is repeated for each new version.

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